



THE RIO GRANDE runs through La Rosita, Texas. Mexico has always repaid its water debts, but the delays have infuriated U.S. farmers.

U.S. threatens drought-hit Mexico with more duties over water debts

Expert on 1944 treaty cited by Trump doubts that new tariffs could improve situation

By KATE LINTHICUM

MEXICO CITY — A war over water is brewing at the U.S.-Mexico border. This week, President Trump threatened Mexico with new tariffs for failing to deliver billions of gallons of water under a 1944 treaty governing the dispersal of

three rivers that run through both countries. “Mexico has been stealing the water from Texas farmers,” Trump wrote on Truth Social, warning that “we will keep escalating consequences, including TARIFFS and, maybe even SANCTIONS, until Mexico honors the Treaty, and GIVES TEXAS THE WA-

TER THEY ARE OWED!” Mexican President Claudia Sheinbaum says her country has not lived up to its treaty commitments because of a relentless drought that has plagued farmers and ranchers in northern Mexico and left a major industrial city with dry taps. On Friday, Sheinbaum vowed Mexico would soon

deliver “a significant amount” of what it owes, and said her government has been meeting with U.S. officials on the matter for months.

She acknowledged the challenges of honoring a pact signed eight decades ago, long before development boomed along the [See Water, A4]

China strikes back in trade war

Responding to Trump’s increased tariffs this week, Beijing hikes them on U.S. goods to 125%. **A3**

Justices restrain Trump’s power to deport

The ruling for a right to a hearing is likely to slow the removals but not to stop them.

By DAVID G. SAVAGE

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court this week put an important check on President Trump’s power to arrest and quickly deport people who are alleged to be members of a foreign crime gang. Those who face deportation “are entitled to notice and opportunity to challenge their removal” before a federal judge, the court said. They must be given “a reasonable time ... that will allow them” to make their case on why they should be spared from deportation, the justices said. “That means that the government cannot usher any detainees onto planes in a shroud of secrecy,” Justice Sonia Sotomayor wrote Monday. She was referring to March 15, when three plane-loads of detained men were flown from Texas to a maximum-security prison in El Salvador. Many of their family [See Deportations, A6]

Soboroff says he was shut out of fire recovery plans

By JULIA WICK

In his last week as L.A.’s fire recovery czar, Steve Soboroff said he was shut out of high-level planning almost from the start, raising questions about why Mayor Karen Bass chose him and whether rebuilding from the Palisades fire is on track. The idiosyncratic long-time civic leader, who has a

penchant for speaking his mind and little patience for stuffed-shirt protocol, was hired for a three-month term at a salary of \$500,000, to be funded by nonprofits. But Soboroff agreed to work for free after searing rebukes from Pacific Palisades residents and others. Soboroff — whose position was announced with fanfare in mid-January — was initially tasked with cre-

ating a comprehensive strategy for rebuilding, but his role was soon dramatically scaled back. “They haven’t asked me to do anything in a month and a half, nothing, zero,” Soboroff said Tuesday in a free-wheeling, 90-minute interview with The Times. But, he insisted, he has still worked long hours helping the Palisades rebuild from a fire that killed 12 peo-

ple and destroyed nearly 7,000 homes and other structures. He has functioned as a fixer of sorts, drawing on his long history as a developer and his bulging Rolodex to connect people, while remaining a frequent presence in the community. A sign of his exclusion from Bass’ inner circle came within two weeks of his appointment, when the mayor [See Soboroff, A7]



CARLIN STEHL For The Times
STEVE SOBOROFF was hired to be L.A.’s fire recovery czar in January for a three-month term.

Rare giant starfish could help restore vanishing kelp forests along the coast



MARCO MAZZA
THE SUNFLOWER sea star is considered functionally extinct in coastal California, Oregon and Washington. Reviving the endangered starfish could help resuscitate struggling kelp forests off the West Coast, marine researchers say.

By LILA SEIDMAN

Ashley Kidd signed onto the Zoom call a few minutes late, giddily explaining that 12 minutes ago there was an unexpected development in a planned spawn of critically endangered starfish. Kidd, conservation project manager with the Sunflower Star Laboratory in the Monterey Bay area, was part of a squad set to travel to an aquarium in Alaska, where the plan was to inject the facility’s sunflower sea stars with a hormone that would induce spawning. Then they would freeze some of the sperm of the males there and take that — plus 10 live, adult starfish and larvae — back with them to the Lower 48. But some of the massive, velvety echinoderms began the spawning process spon- [See Starfish, A10]

Activist subject to deportation
Columbia University grad student, a legal U.S. resident, poses a national security risk, an immigration judge finds. **NATION, A5**

Edison to bury power cables
Plan includes more than 150 miles of lines in January fire areas. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Balancing tech and tradition
Augusta National changing with the times amid advent of AI and drones at the Masters. **SPORTS, B12**

Weather
Fog, then sun.
L.A. Basin: 76/55. **B8**

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